

Jaguar I-PACE sounds its approach for the blind

One of the best things about electric cars is that they operate silently – a bit too silently even, it seems. Like many car makers before it, Jaguar has decided to equip its latest electric soft-roader with an audible alert system. Dubbed Audible Vehicle Alert System (or AVAS), the system creates a sound that can be heard outside the car at speeds below 20 kilometres per hour. This system allows the blind, the visually impaired, and other vulnerable road users to become aware of the car's presence around them. Pedestrians have long been used to hearing the sound of internal



combustion engines at a zebra crossing and on the roads.. With electric cars being completely silent, this necessary aural feedback is completely absent. AVAS creates an artificial but credible engine sound for pedestrians around it. The I-PACE's soundtrack was tested by members of Guide Dogs for the Blind, a British charity. AVAS was developed and perfected over a period of four years by Jaguar engineers. Jaguar unveiled the I-PACE earlier this year and even showcased it in this year's Paris Motor Show.

Link: <https://digit.in/jagipace>



Reliance aims to pilot personal rapid transit systems based on magnetic levitation in India

RIL has announced that it has acquired a 12.7% shareholding in SkyTran Inc, which is in the business of developing high-end transportation systems. SkyTran has 8 approved patents and 40+ patents pending approval, globally, including in India, and Reliance will also be nominating a director on the Board of SkyTran following its investment in the company. What's more exciting is that RIL aims to foster pilot implementation of SkyTran's computer-controlled passenger pods that travel using patented Passive Magnetic Levitation in India, followed by a larger implementation of the transport network at scale in the country. SkyTran's transportation system uses predictive AI to know when passengers need a ride. The magnetically levitating pods dock into stations that can fit on top of sidewalks, creating a small footprint, making them easy to implement. Since these pods are designed to facilitate personal transport, they do not have to make stops for other passengers and directly reach the rider's destination without added delays. Travel speeds can vary anywhere between 80 kph to a whopping 321 kph. SkyTran claims that their systems are low-cost, making them easier to build at scale.

Link: <https://digit.in/remaglev>

Government to issue uniform Smart Driver's License and RCs featuring NFC and QR codes starting 2019

Driving licences and vehicle registration certificates issued from July 2019 will carry a uniform look, design, and colour across all states and union territories in the country. They will be uniformly sized cards that come with a few security features as standard. The new 'smart' driving licences and registration certificates will come with a microchip embedded in them. They will have two new features: they will be NFC-enabled and will come with a QR code printed on them. Expected to look more like an ATM card or a Metro Rail card, they can easily be read by traffic enforcers to get details about a vehicle or its driver. Apart from these new



changes, the new driving licences will contain information about the driver's blood group and a special declaration by the driver if they choose to donate their organs. The licences will also contain a special note in case the driver is driving a vehicle especially designed for the physically challenged. The new 'smart' driving licences and registration certificates should allow for a more convenient and paper-free motoring experience

in the country. One thing's for sure though: the new driving licence, with its new NFC chip and all, is becoming less and less photocopyable.

Link: <https://digit.in/smdrive>